

Django provides. Such is the case with our application which takes advantage of a lot that Django offers. Not all of it of course, but whatever we don't use can be disabled and mostly doesn't affect the performance.

Django also happens to include common sense security mechanisms that protect you from CSRF (Cross Site Request Forgery), XSS (Cross Site Scripting), SQL Injection, Clickjacking, etc. It abstracts the database you use so you can use a single-file SQLite database during testing and development and move to Postgres, or MariaDB, in production without needing any code changes in most cases.

All of this makes Django well suitable for building our CMS from scratch with a good feature set, in minimal time, but without compromising on security.

Installing Django

There are many ways to get Django but the most straightforward and recommended way is to install it using `pip` the official Python package manager.

With pip installing Django is as simple as running:

- `pip install django`

Running the above in a command shell will install Django for the current default Python version. If you are using virtual environments as recommended in the previous chapter, it will install within the virtual environment and leave your main system clean.

There are actually a number of different versions of Django that you can currently get and install. Every so often a Django release is marked as LTS or Long Term Support, and this release is supported and patched for a longer period (3 years) than usual. Currently both the previous LTS version (1.4) and current LTS version (1.8) are supported, and the previous version of Django (1.7) is supported as well. For our purposes there is no reason to use any version other than 1.8 and that is the version that will be installed when you run the command mentioned before. If you are reading this booklet a long time after it came out, chances are a new version of Django is out. The CMS we developed here should still work, however if you face issues you can force pip to install a specific version of Django by specifying its version number as follows:

- `pip install django==1.8.3`

Here 1.8.3 is the current version of Django. A better way to do this though is to use the following command:

- `pip install "django<1.9"`